

Family, Medical, and Parental Leave Policy

Policy ID	HR-LEAVE-201	Owner	People Operations
Effective	January 1, 2026	Next review	January 1, 2027
Status	Current	Classification	Internal
Audience	Eligible employees and people managers	Company	Northstar Technologies (fictional)

Document notice: This policy is fictional and was created for retrieval-augmented generation testing. It is not legal, tax, medical, or employment advice.

1. Purpose and Scope

This policy describes extended job-protected leave for an employee's serious health condition, care of an eligible family member, birth, adoption, foster placement, and qualifying military family needs. Local law controls when it provides greater protection.

This policy applies across company offices and approved remote locations unless a local addendum or controlling law provides a different rule. Employees should use the current policy version and ask the listed owner when facts do not fit the standard case.

2. Summary of Key Rules

Program	Typical eligibility	Maximum company designation	Pay source
Family or medical	12 months and 1,250 hours	12 weeks in 12 months	Accrued leave or unpaid
Parental bonding	6 months of service	8 weeks in first 12 months	4 weeks company paid
Military caregiver	As required by local law	Up to 26 weeks	Accrued leave or unpaid

3. Notice and Certification

When the need is foreseeable, employees should provide 30 days' notice. When it is not foreseeable, notice should be provided as soon as practicable. People Operations may request certification containing duration and work restrictions, but managers should not request a diagnosis. Incomplete certification may delay designation after the employee is given a reasonable opportunity to correct it.

4. Intermittent and Reduced Schedule Leave

Approved medical leave may be taken intermittently or on a reduced schedule when supported by certification. Employees should make a reasonable effort to schedule planned treatment without unduly disrupting operations. Intermittent bonding leave requires manager and People Operations approval unless local law provides otherwise. Time is tracked in the smallest increment used for other leave, up to one hour.

5. Pay and Benefits

Protected leave is unpaid unless the employee elects or is required to use available paid leave or qualifies for company-paid parental leave. Health coverage continues on the same employee contribution terms while the leave remains protected. Failure to pay the employee share after written notice may result in coverage suspension where permitted. Retirement contributions are based only on eligible paid earnings.

6. Return, Reinstatement, and Confidentiality

Employees should contact People Operations before the expected return date. A fitness-for-duty release may be required when disclosed in the designation notice. Eligible employees are generally restored to the same or an equivalent role, subject to lawful exceptions. Leave records and medical certifications are restricted and stored separately from ordinary manager files.

7. Exceptions, Records, and Questions

Exceptions must be lawful, documented, limited in duration, and approved by the policy owner plus any other owner named in the relevant section. Approval for one case does not change the policy for other employees. Records are retained according to the company retention schedule and any legal hold.

Related documents: Sick and Wellness Leave Policy; Benefits Eligibility and Enrollment Guide; Workplace Accommodation Procedure.

Version history

Version	Effective date	Change
1.0	January 1, 2026	Initial fictional policy issued for RAG evaluation.